Apple Inc.

AAPL NASDAQ

Hold	$343.49 ▲ 0.65%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$355.00	$243.42 – $348.15	$5.01T

AAPL: Near All-Time Highs But Insiders Are Dumping

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL ticked up 0.65% to $343.49, sitting at 96% of its 52-week range — basically kissing all-time highs. Nothing earth-shattering overnight, but the real story is under the hood: Tim Cook dumped over $50M of stock on Oct 2, and someone just bought 115,000 put contracts (bets the stock goes DOWN) at the $345 strike. That's 30x the normal open interest — a very big, very targeted bearish wager.
- Volume today was light (22M vs. the usual 35M+), which means this grind higher isn't being backed by heavy conviction buying — it's drifting up on thin air.

WHY IT MATTERS

When the CEO sells $50M of stock near all-time highs AND someone places a $15M bet that the stock drops in the next two weeks, you pay attention — that's two independent signals saying "near-term upside is limited." This doesn't mean AAPL is broken; it means the easy money from the recent run has been made, and smart money is positioning for a pullback or at minimum a pause. The bigger picture: Apple is caught between two political crosscurrents — the Trump administration's tariff posture on China (where Apple still makes ~80% of iPhones) and the ongoing DOJ antitrust case targeting the App Store's 30% commission. Either one going badly is a direct hit to earnings, and the stock is priced like neither will matter.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch right now: (1) China tariff policy — the administration has been using tariff threats as leverage in trade talks, and any escalation on electronics imports directly compresses Apple's margins since they can't move iPhone assembly out of China fast enough. (2) The DOJ's antitrust case against Apple's App Store is still grinding forward — if courts force Apple to allow sideloading apps or cut its 30% commission, Services revenue (the highest-margin part of the business) takes a real hit. On the positive side, the CHIPS Act subsidies continue to benefit Apple's U.S. chip supply chain via TSMC Arizona, which is a quiet tailwind nobody talks about.

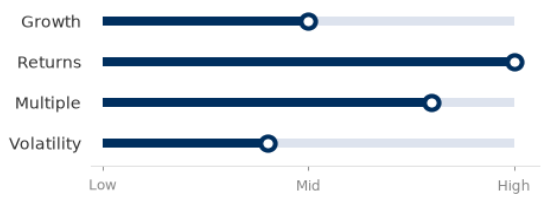
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~44x forward earnings — meaning you're paying $44 for every $1 of profit Apple makes next year — this is historically expensive for Apple (its 10-year average is closer to 20-25x). The premium is being paid for the AI narrative and the Services growth story, but revenue is only growing mid-single-digits, so you're paying a hypergrowth multiple for a mature-growth business. Translation: a lot has to go right from here to justify the price.

Key Data

Price (USD)	**$343.49**
12M Price Target	**$355.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+3.4%**
Market Cap	**$5.01T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$445M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$478M**
FY2026E EPS	**$7.85**
FY2027E EPS	**$8.60**
Fwd P/E	**43.8x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

AAPL — Apple Inc. | October 14, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$355.00**	$342.00	**$320.00**
6 Months	**$380.00**	$350.00	**$300.00**
1 Year	**$410.00**	$355.00	**$285.00**
2 Years	**$475.00**	$390.00	**$270.00**
5 Years	**$650.00**	$500.00	**$300.00**
10 Years	**$1000.00**	$700.00	**$350.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+2.12%) and Consumer Staples (+1.47%) — classic defensive rotation. When money runs to healthcare and staples, it usually means investors are getting nervous about growth and want earnings they can count on. Energy continues its multi-day run (+6.6% over 5 days), likely on geopolitical tension and OPEC supply discipline.

COOLING OFF: Real Estate, Materials, and Utilities are all red — rate-sensitive sectors are getting hit, which suggests the market is pricing in "higher for longer" rates again.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving defensive (healthcare, staples) rather than into tech — that's a yellow flag for AAPL. When defensives lead, big-cap tech often takes a breather.

RELATED PLAY: If you want AI exposure without AAPL's China tariff risk, look at the semiconductor equipment names and U.S.-based cloud/AI infrastructure plays that benefit from the same AI trend but have less direct geopolitical risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Pure AI play without the hardware/China exposure — enterprise AI monetization through Azure and Copilot is the cleaner story right now.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Trading at a cheaper multiple than Apple with arguably better AI positioning via Gemini and TPU chips.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple has led mega-cap tech into these highs, but it's doing so with the weakest revenue growth of the group — that's a late-cycle setup. When the slowest grower leads, it usually means we're closer to a top than a bottom for the trade.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Apple is a world-class business but you're buying it at a nosebleed multiple with insiders selling and smart money positioning bearish for the next 2 weeks. Not a sell, but not a chase.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% as a core holding — this is a sleep-at-night name, but don't overweight it at these levels.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for $315-325, which would be a healthy 7-10% pullback. The massive put buying at $345 tells me someone with real money thinks that pullback is coming soon.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the real catalyst is whether the iPhone AI upgrade cycle materializes in FY27 and whether Services keeps growing double-digits.

WHEN TO BAIL: If China tariffs escalate hard, if the DOJ wins its antitrust case in a damaging way, or if iPhone revenue declines two quarters in a row — any of those breaks the story.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge: buy a put option (think of it as insurance) at the $320 strike expiring in 3 months. Costs you a small premium but caps your downside if the bearish options flow is right.

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